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Title	Product Safety
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Prepared By	Owner
Approved By	Jacob Honick, Owner
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QP-017 Product Safety

Standards and clause references are guidance only and do not claim certification or standard compliance. Applicable customer, contractual and legal requirements govern accepted work.

1. Purpose

Define the process for identifying safety-critical items, managing associated risks, and ensuring timely notification and escalation when safety-related nonconformances or concerns arise.

2. Scope

Applies to all products manufactured or processed that have been identified as safety-critical by the customer, drawing, or specification.

3. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Shop Owner	Identify safety-critical items from customer data, ensure awareness at point of manufacture, escalate and notify customers immediately upon discovery of safety-related nonconformances, maintain safety records

4. References

- QP-008 — Nonconforming Product Control
- QP-023 — Customer Communication and Complaints
- QP-007 — Final Inspection and Product Release
- QF-011 — Nonconforming Material Report
- AS9100 Rev D Clause 8.1.1 (Operational Risk Management)

5. Definitions

- **Safety-Critical Item:** Any part, assembly, or characteristic whose failure could cause loss of life, serious injury, or loss of a major system (as designated by the customer or regulatory authority).
- **Key Characteristic:** A feature whose variation has a significant effect on product fit, performance, or safety.
- **Immediate Notification:** Within 24 hours of discovery.

6. Procedure

Identification of Safety-Critical Items

1. At contract review/order entry, review customer drawings, purchase orders, and specifications for safety-critical designations (S-critical notes, inverted delta symbols, "Safety" callouts, or customer-specific notation).
2. Flag identified safety-critical items on the Job Traveler and Work Order. Note the specific characteristic(s) designated as safety-critical.
3. The owner reviews safety-critical status before accepting and starting the job and communicates applicable requirements to the customer and customer-approved external suppliers. No additional shop personnel are implied.

Awareness and Controls

1. Ensure operators are aware of which characteristics are safety-critical on their current job (verbal briefing at job start, noted on traveler).
2. Apply additional verification to safety-critical characteristics: 100% inspection of those dimensions/features (no sampling).
3. Record inspection results for safety-critical characteristics with individual measurement values (not pass/fail only).

Nonconformance Escalation

1. If a nonconformance is discovered on a safety-critical characteristic:
    - Immediately STOP production on the affected operation.
    - Quarantine ALL parts from the affected lot (conforming and nonconforming).

    - Initiate QF-011 with "SAFETY-CRITICAL" clearly noted.
    - Perform a look-back: determine if any previously produced parts from the same setup could be affected.
2. Notify the customer within 24 hours of discovery. Record notification details on QF-011.
3. Do NOT disposition safety-critical nonconformances as "Use-As-Is" without WRITTEN customer authorization.

Reporting Obligations

1. If safety-critical nonconforming product has already been shipped, immediately notify the customer per QP-023.
2. Retain all records related to safety-critical nonconformances under QP-001 and SUP-003 for at least ten years after the relevant last shipment, the life of the part, or the customer/contract/legal requirement, whichever is longest.

7. Records Generated

Form No.	Title	When Completed
QF-011	Nonconforming Material Report (Safety-Critical)	When safety-critical nonconformance is identified
Job Traveler (safety flag)	Safety-critical job notation	At contract review for safety-critical items

8. Revision History

Rev	Date	Description	Approved By
A	2026-08-07	Initial release	Shop Owner

Revision B Approval

Approved 2026-11-05 by Jacob Honick, Owner. Standardize control metadata and annual review, remove fixed page counts and align applicable references and wording.